



Marching on the Pentagon

On October 21, 1967, around 100,000 antiwar protesters gathered at the Lincoln Memorial, Washington, D.C. When some proceeded to march on the Pentagon, the demonstration turned into a riot, leading to 682 arrests.

Students and hippies

In the mid-1960s, the antiwar movement gained a particular momentum on college campuses, largely provoked by the increase in draft calls. Some students conflated resistance to university authority and challenges to government authority. Demonstrations on campuses voiced opposition to military recruitment, private-sector recruitment for government contractors such as Dow Chemical (the manufacturer of napalm), and university research on behalf of the military. Police brutality against these student protesters often became the antiwar movement's most effective recruiting tool, as hitherto apolitical bystanders became radicalized at the sight of violence against their classmates.

Many observers characterized antiwar protestors as “drop outs” or “hippies”—followers of the 1960s' counterculture. Although there was overlap between these groups, especially among white, middle-class youth, the antiwar movement also included working-class people and people of color who objected to the draft.

Due to its links to other such movements, antiwar activism became associated with radical political and social ideas. The seemingly radical tactics, methods, and language of many of those who spoke out against the war could also dissuade some groups—such as older people and political conservatives—from engaging with protesters, even if these groups shared many of the protesters' concerns about the war.